



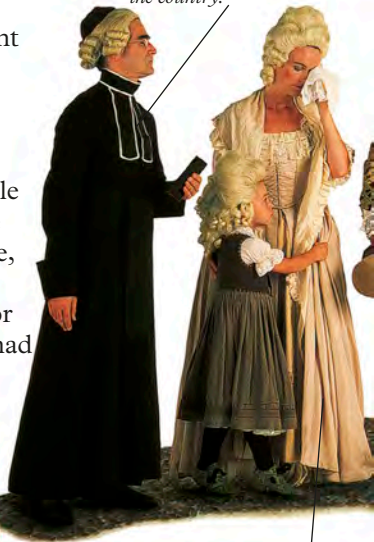
REVOLUTION



Detail from a French revolution poster

In the 18th century, an important revolution started in France. It happened because the king, Louis XVI, and his nobles held all the power and wealth in the country. He could rule the people as he pleased. The way he chose to do so was unfair. For example, the nobles, who were already rich, paid no taxes while the poor peasants did. In 1789, the king had nearly run out of money. He wanted to increase taxes. At the same time, food was very scarce because of bad harvests. The ordinary people had had enough and decided that they didn't want to be ruled by the king. Louis was executed and a new government was set up.

The revolutionaries were against organized religion and many clergymen fled the country.



Nobles were thought to be enemies of the revolution. Some were arrested and went to the guillotine.

The revolution was supported by people who thought they had been badly treated by their rulers. They included lawyers, traders, small farmers, workers, and ordinary soldiers.



The nobles made fun of the simple clothes of the revolutionaries. They called them "sans-culottes," people without the fine knee-length breeches the nobles wore.

Women played an important part in revolutionary events. They led many of the marches.